

OCR quality is not what limits the dataset

Share of the 1,333 biographical notices from which each field could be read, by quartile of the notice's mean per-word OCR confidence (median 0.920, range 0.670–0.997). Recovery barely moves. The cleanest quartile records a birth year least often, which is a composition effect and not a legibility one — those notices are the longest in the volume (595 characters at the median against 355 in the worst quartile); they simply do not print a date.

